

SOLAR PANEL DEPENDENCE

98%
WAFER

100%
POLYSILICON

90%
VITAL UPSTREAM
TOOLS

BUILT ON IMPORTS • RENEWABLES



HARNESSING THE SUN Photovoltaic panels at a solar farm in Pavagada, Karnataka

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GREEN GRID, RED FLAGS

INDIA'S SOLAR INSTALLATIONS HAVE MULTIPLIED TENFOLD IN THE PAST DECADE BUT IT'S HEAVILY DEPENDENT ON IMPORTS WITH 98% OF WAFERS AND 100% OF POLYSILICON SOURCED FROM CHINA

BY **RICHA SHARMA**

INDIA HAS A solar module manufacturing capacity of over 200 GW a year but only the capacity to make 27 GW of cells, the primary component to convert sunshine into electricity. This means solar module manufacturing in India is built on imports.

This poses a big risk because any global value chain disruption due to events such as Covid-19 could dent India's renewable energy growth led by solar and battery storage due to its heavy import dependence on China.